

Quantum Game Jam: Simple Guidelines

Plain-text expectations and rules for participants

1. Core Goal

Make a game where the player naturally learns a quantum computing or quantum physics concept simply by playing it.

2. Topic First, Graphics Second

- Do not spend your time on fancy 3D models or complex visual shaders.
- Focus your effort on making the quantum topic clear, accurate, and easy to understand.

3. Wrap the Entire Game Around the Concept

- Do not take an ordinary game and just add quantum buzzwords to it.
- The core mechanics and win conditions must come directly from real quantum phenomena (such as superposition, measurement collapse, entanglement, or quantum gates).

4. Accessible to Beginners

- A player with only basic high school math and science should be able to pick up the game and understand the concept.
- Avoid heavy math formulas, advanced linear algebra, or confusing notation unless your gameplay explains them intuitively.

5. Recommended Approach: Learn, Struggle, Build

- Spend the first few hours of the hackathon researching a quantum topic your team does not fully understand yet.
- Pay attention to what feels confusing or counterintuitive during your learning process.
- Build your game mechanics specifically to solve that confusion for the next person.

6. Original Ideas Only

Do not copy existing quantum games or direct clones. Create an original take or an intuitive mechanic of your own.

7. Platform and Hosting

- Web games (playable directly in the browser) are strongly preferred so judges and players can test them without installation.
- Having the game hosted online and ready to play (e.g., on itch.io, GitHub Pages, Vercel) is even better.
- Desktop or mobile apps are permitted, but web versions will receive priority consideration.